Ans. India has achieved a record foodgrain production of 241 million tonnes (MT) in the 2010-11 crop year with record production in wheat, maize and pulses. This has really encouraged the hope of attaining food security for the country. We may analyse it as given below:

(i) India's population growth rate at present is 1.76 per cent (as per the provisional data of census 2011) while its foodgrain growth rate is just at about 'one per ent per year (since 1996-97). It put a pressure of 0.76 per cent per year on production of the foodgrains.

(ii) As per the latest data released by the Governement of India, by 2020-21 the country will need a total of 281 MT of food grains for its consumptuion – it is only possible once we are able to achieve a 2 per cent annual growth rate in foodgrain production.

(iii) Once the Universal Right to food becomes effective, the real pressure on the physical availability of foodgrain will start showing up.

(iv) Scarcity of foodgrains has been a major reason for their price rise in the recent years, as with increasing income, there is increased demand of food grains from the newer population of the country.

In the process of attaininy food security the Government is going for a multi-dimensional approach:

(i) second green revolution with emphasis on plant protection, organic farming, new seeds, use of bio-tech, etc.

(ii) promoting contract and corporate farming.

(iii) Action and policies regarding the effects of climate change on agriculture.

(iv) Marketing and distribution reform.

(v) Targeting agricultural subsidies in a right way.

(vi) Promoting agricultural research through private-public participation.

(vii) Trying to make farming a remunerative profession.

Q. 22 Write a note on the strategy of monitorable development targets initiated by the Eleventh Five-Year Plan.